CHAPTER 2
HISTORY OF HYPNOSIS

Shamanism in Ancient Egypt
Dark Room

EGYPTIAN SLEEP TEMPLE

THE GREEK TEMPLE OF ASKLEPIOS

THE EGYPTIAN TEMPLE OF IMHOTEP

ANCIENT CHRISTIANITY OF HYPNOSIS

the modern fundamental Christian perspective
Hypnosis is a tool for expanding awareness
beyond the five senses

see [visual: V],
hear [auditory: A],
feeling [kinesthetic: K],
smell [olfactory: O],
taste [gustatory: G]

Anton Mesmer

"Hypnosis entered the
modern medical world
in the 1772 when a
German physician,
Anton Mesmer (1734-1815),
introduced his theory
of animal magnetism."

"One of Mesmer's disciples, Marquis de Puysegur, believed that the cosmic fluid described by Mesmer was not magnetic, but electric."

John Elliotson

"In the 1840's a British surgeon, John Elliotson (1791-1868), performed many operations painlessly using animal magnetism."

Dr. Esdaile

Another British physician, Dr. Esdaile (1808-1859), observed a demonstration of animal magnetism while on vacation in England. He returned to India and performed over
3,000 operations in a prison hospital using nothing but animal magnetism.

James Braid

“In 1840, the word "hypnosis" was coined by James Braid (1795-1860). Braid stumbled upon the state when, while treating a patient with an eye disorder, another man
requiring immediate attention arrived at Braid’s office.”

“Braid decided that the state was a nervous sleep.”

“Braid‘s research in hypnosis was published in many languages before he realized that the state is not sleep. When he tried to rename the phenomena "mono-ideaism" in order to more accurately describe the enhanced awareness and focal capacity of the hypnosis experience, but "hypnosis" was already accepted as the common term, and has
remained so until the present.”

Dr. Jean Martin Charcot

“In the late 1870s, Dr. Jean Martin Charcot (1825-1893), a neurologist and head of the School of Salpetriere in France, described three states of hypnosis:”

1 - lethargy, (physical relaxation),

2 - catalepsy, (limbs remaining in any position they are placed),

3 - somnambulism (able to walk, talk and be anesthetized).

“During the 1880s, two French physicians, Hippolyte Bernheim (1837-1919) and Auguste Ambroise Liebeault (1823-1904), established a joint practice adopting Braid's ideas
of induction via suggestion.”

“Their work was so successful that physicians
from around the world came to study, including Sigmund Freud. Freud was researching the use of hypnosis to unlock repressed memories, and was not a good student of hypnosis because of his mistaken belief that deep trance was needed for

hypnotic success. Freud, as with many modern hypnotists, was only able to obtain deep trance with a small percentage of his clients."

"His colleague, Joseph Breuer (1842 - 1925), was the leading medical hypnotist of the day. Breuer discovered that symptoms were reduced or disappeared after the subject was able to describe their experience. He developed the concept of using catharsis as a tool for healing, with hypnosis to accelerate the process"

After discussing Breuer's findings with him, Freud put aside hypnosis and developed his theories of psychoanalysis. He took a position that humans have both conscious and unconscious processes. Using an iceberg or island as the model, the observed portion above the water represents conscious processes, the submerged portion represents unconscious processes. Carl Jung (1875-1961) added a collective unconcious to Freud's concepts of depth psychology and the structure of personality.

Emile Couie

"Emile Couie (1857-1926), a French lay psychotherapist, founded a therapeutic method based on the auto-suggestion(self induced suggestion), "Day by day and in every
way I am getting better and better."

Phineas Quimby

Phineas Quimby, a European mesmerist, toured the United States working with people suffering from all types of illnesses. One woman he helped, Mary Morse (nee Baker) Eddie (1821-1910), studied with him and went on to found the Christian Science Church. Mary Baker Eddie refused to use the word hypnosis or mention it as part of the foundation for her teachings, she renamed this familiar process the Science of the Mind. Her teachings incorporated awareness of the positive and negative effect of belief on themind.

Edgar Cayce

In 1901, a man named Edgar Cayce discovered he could diagnose illnesses and treatments while in trance. Edgar Cayce, the Sleeping Prophet, would give detailed diagnosis of clients' problems without ever meeting some of them in person. Cayce's capacities point to the transpersonal or non-local aspects of mind and being. Cayce died in 1945, but his large library of material which he obtained remotely during trance are available for research at the Association for Research and Enlightenment(A.R.E.) in Virginia Beach.

Milton Erickson

Milton Erickson (1901-1980) is known as the founder of modern medical hypnosis. He contracted polio as a kid and had to relearn how to walk, which he did by watching his
younger sibling (sister?). His style is a storytelling, non-directive style of hypnotic interventions for improved health.

Dave Elman

In 1908, an eight year old boy named Dave Elman became interested in hypnosis. His father was dying of cancer, and a stage hypnotist helped Dave's father live pain free forthe last weeks of his life. Elman was inspired. He read everything he could find abouthypnosis. Everything he read indicated that a successful hypnotic induction might takeanywhere from several minutes to several hours, and required a bright light or other fixation device. While practicing, Elman noticed boredom and eye fatigue. He learned from an eye doctor how to obtain eye fatigue more rapidly, and developed methods of hypnotic
induction that reduced the induction time tremendously. Methods such as the Elman Two Finger Technique made hypnosis a more viable tool for medicaluse (see Elman, Hypnotherapy, Chapter 7, pp.41-50). Elman concluded that the subject was always in complete control, able to suspend disbelief from what he called the critical faculty or critical factor of the mind, and able to receive pleasing suggestions. He noted that when improper suggestions were was given, one of two things happened: the subject would reject the suggestion, and/or terminate trance.

"There were only a couple hundred people in the United State using hypnosis in 1945. By 1955, the British Medical Association reported that hypnosis was a valuable tool in medical treatment. It urged that hypnosis be taught in medical schools, and finally gave a nod of approval for physicians to openly learn and practice hypnosis. In 1958, hypnosis was given approval as a medical modality by the American Medical Association."

"In 1975, the title Hypnotherapist (079.157.010) was listed in the Dictionary of Occupational Titles published by the U.S. Department of Labor. There are thousands of trained hypnotists worldwide. Nonetheless, there are organizations actively seeking to limit the free and open practice of hypnosis."

"There were only a couple hundred people in the United State using hypnosis in 1945. By 1955, the British Medical Association reported that hypnosis was a valuable tool in medical treatment. It urged that hypnosis be taught in medical schools, and finally gave a nod of approval for physicians to openly learn and practice hypnosis. In 1958,

hypnosis was given approval as a medical modality by the American Medical Association."

"In 1975, the title Hypnotherapist (079.157.010) was listed in the Dictionary of Occupational Titles published by the U.S. Department of Labor. There are thousands of trained hypnotists worldwide. Nonetheless, there are organizations actively seeking to limit the free and open practice of hypnosis."

BLESSINGS SCHOOL OF HYPNOSIS